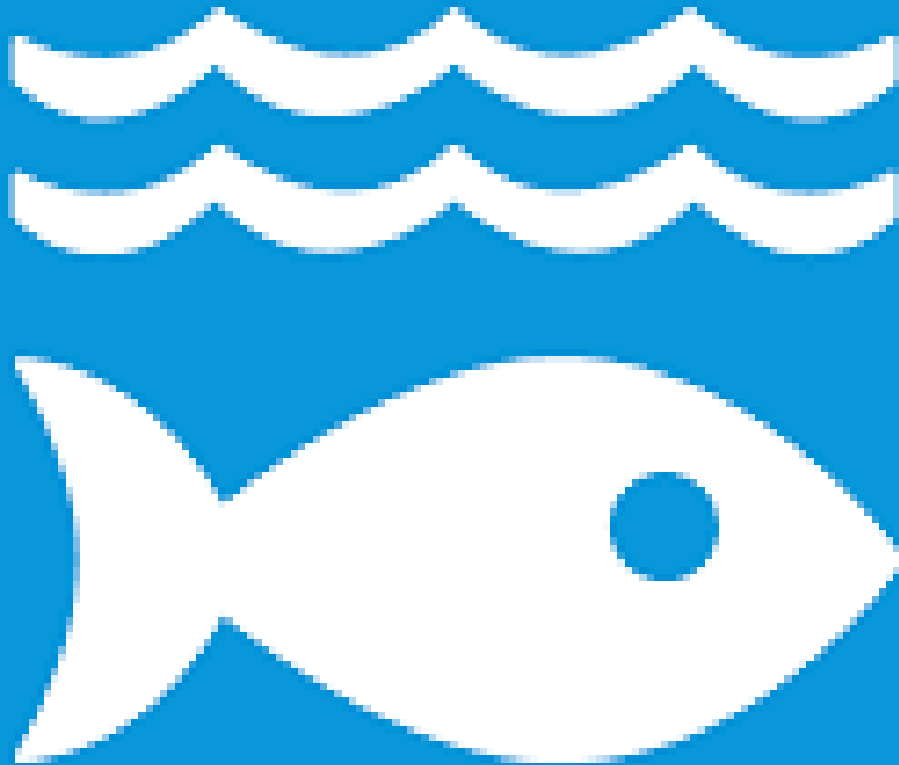




# Investigation Log



# 14 LIFE BELOW WATER



The UN target that connects to this issue is the [United Nations Sustainable Development Goal 14: Life Below Water](#) that conserves and sustainably uses the oceans, seas, and marine resources for sustainable development.

The lobster industry is currently stable and healthy in the present but moving further into the future is when there are potential risks regarding the Nova Scotia lobster industry. Over the next 20 years, the lobster industry may face major changes as the rising ocean temperatures in the North Atlantic Ocean may shift the lobster population further north into more colder and deeper water. Lobsters prefer colder waters so the continuing warming could increase stress and disease in lobsters. This will not only make them migrate but also ruins the quality of lobster as they would molt more and the warm temperature can affect their growth and survival rates. Since the lobster industry is a major part in the economy of Nova Scotia, these environmental changes can affect the fishing communities and the overall economy of Nova Scotia. We may need more strong and impactful environmental protections to protect the lobster population and to support coastal economies. Hence, We can try to support the lobster industry in protecting the lobsters and providing fishermen a alternate option if the lobsters were to fully migrate towards the north in the next 20 years.

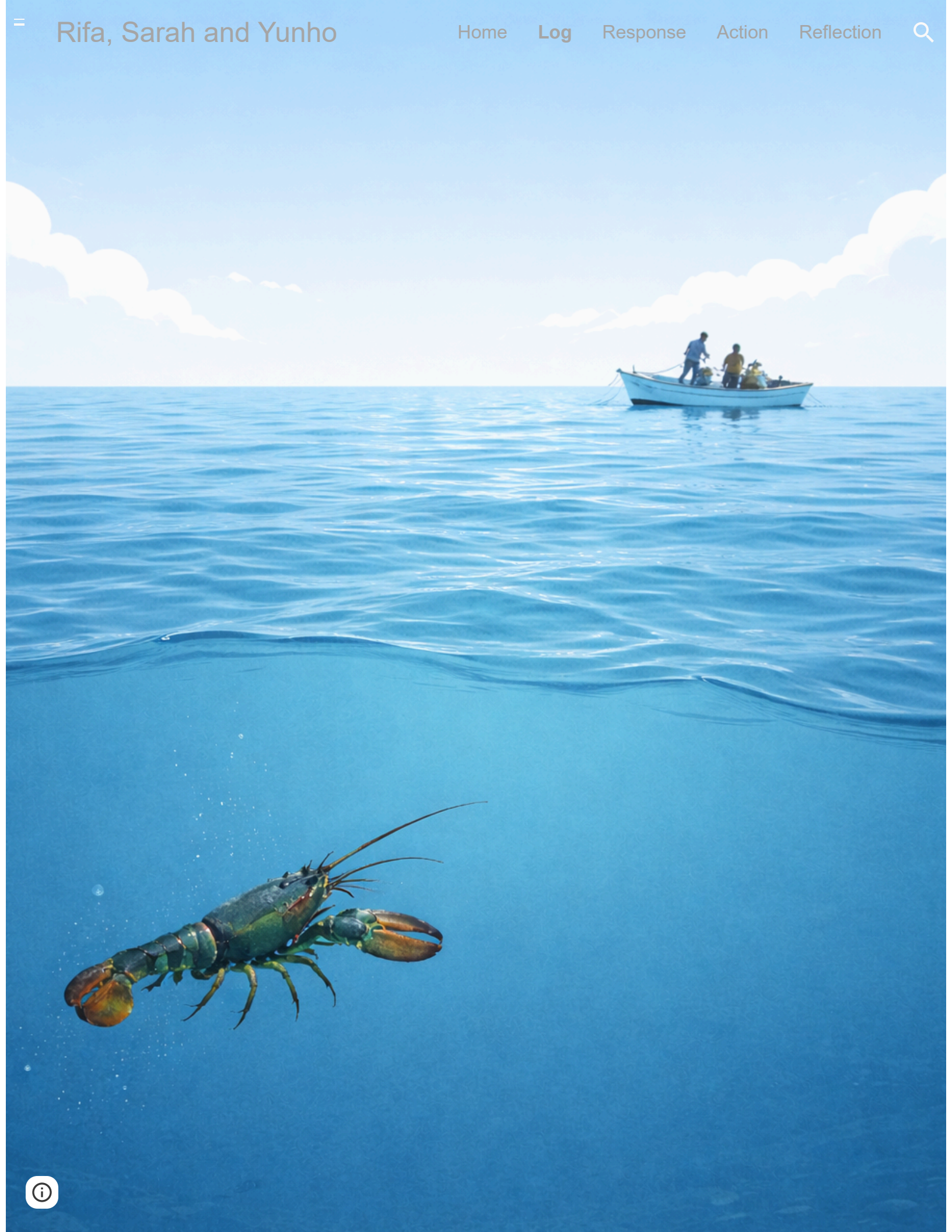
**Timeline:**

**2025 - Rising temperature**

**2035 - Lobster migration shifts**

**2045 - Industry adaptation needed**





## ■ Human Impact: A "lived experience" story. What does this issue feel like for a real person in NS?

There have been a lot of reports about climate change, and because of climate change, the water temperatures around Nova Scotia is getting warmer every year. The ocean temperature is risking future problems for fisheries, which makes it even harder to catch marine creatures and lobsters compared to before.

George Russell Jr., from the NunnatuKavut Community, said that he felt very worried about how the fish and lobster population are decreasing. He said some fish die because of the heat, and some lobsters move to colder waters in other places, which may include moving from Canada to another country, making it harder to catch the same amount of lobsters as before. He thinks this will make families who depend on fishing for their living will feel at risk, which is the most stressful part of this situation.

This problem also affected the community, not only the fisheries. Families in small coastal towns depended on fishing for money to provide for their families, so when the catch was less than before, people started worrying about next year. Because they were not sure if it would be better or worse than it already is.

The community and people also felt frustrated because climate change is not something they can control, but it is changing their lives and way of living. For someone living in Nova Scotia, this issue does not feel like just science news; it feels like worry, pressure, and uncertainty every time they go to or near the ocean.

**\*The NunnatuKavut Community represents all the people living in that place / who are part of this community are also facing the same situation, so they are included.**

**Page Authored by ALL TEAM MEMBERS**

**Research sourced by Sarah**